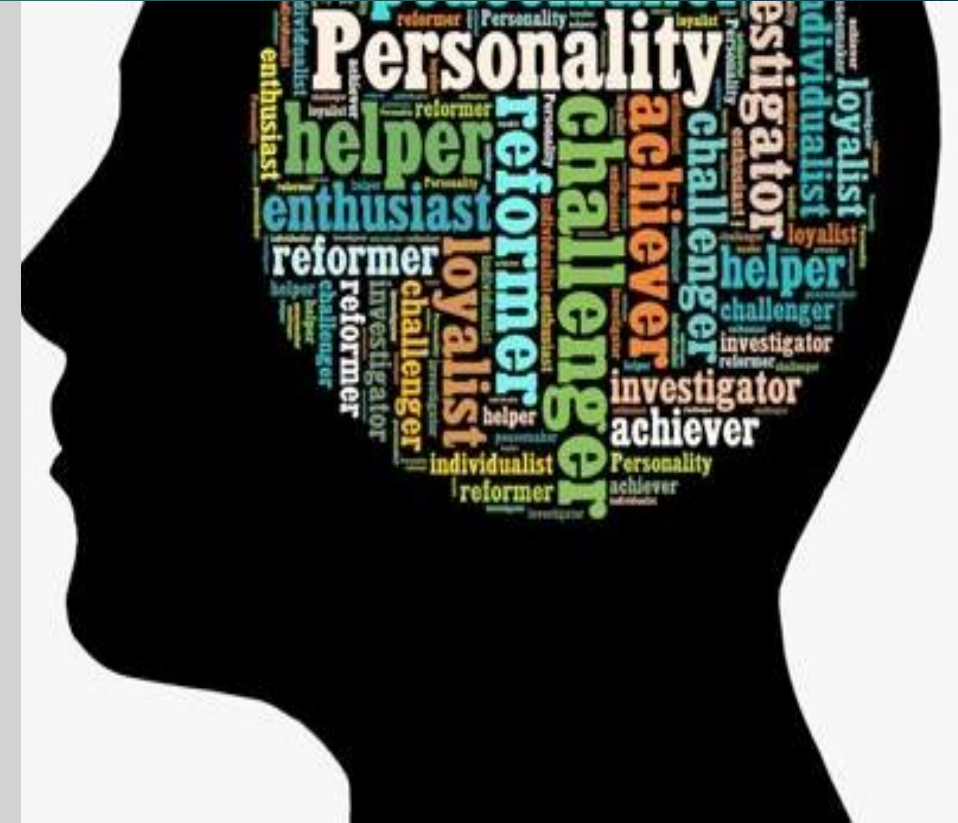


Chapter 05

Personality and Values



Personality refers to individual differences in characteristic patterns of thinking, feeling and behaving.

Personality traits are enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior.

What is Personality?

- How would you define personality?
- “Personality psychologists” study how people:

THINK



FEEL



BEHAVE



- Your personality is a relatively stable combination of these characteristics

Measuring Personality

The most important reason managers need to know how to measure personality is that research has shown personality tests are useful in hiring decisions and help managers forecast who is best for a job

- self-report survey
- Observer-ratings survey

The implication is clear: use both observer ratings and self-report ratings of personality when making important employment decisions.

Personality Determinants

An early debate in personality research centered on whether an individual's personality was the result of **heredity or of environment**. It appears to be a result of both.

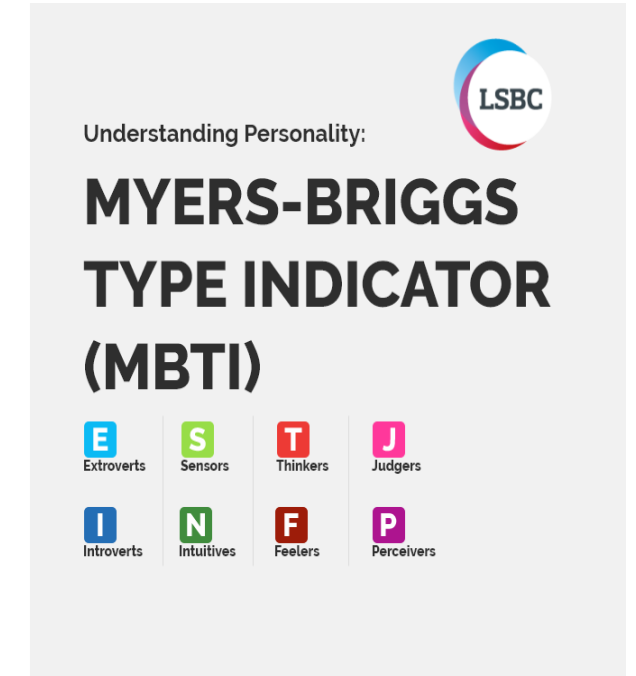
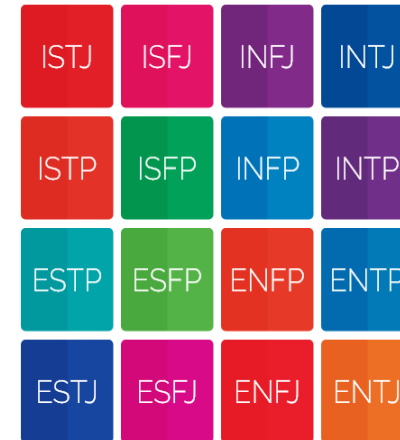
- The heredity approach argues that the ultimate explanation of an individual's personality is the molecular structure of the genes, located in the chromosomes.
- Early work on the structure of personality tried to identify and label enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior, including shy, aggressive,, lazy, ambitious and loyal etc.
- When someone exhibits these characteristics in a large number of situations, we call them **personality traits** of that person.

Two Major models of personality testing

- Myers-Briggs Type Indicator
 - Big Five Model

The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator

- The **Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)** is the most widely used personality assessment instrument in the world.
- Respondents are classified as extraverted or introverted (E or I), sensing or intuitive (S or N), thinking or feeling (T or F), and judging or perceiving (J or P).
- These classifications together describe **16 personality** types, identifying every person by one trait from each of the four pairs.



Extraverted (E) Extraverted individuals are outgoing, sociable, and assertive.	Introverted (I). Introverts are quiet and shy.
<i>Sensing (S)</i> Sensing types are practical and prefer routine and order. They focus on details	<i>Intuitive (N)</i> Intuitive rely on unconscious processes and look at the “big picture.”
<i>Thinking (T)</i> Thinking types use reason and logic to handle problems.	<i>Feeling (F)</i> Feeling types rely on their personal values and emotions.
<i>Judging (J)</i> Judging types want control and prefer their world to be ordered and structured.	<i>Perceiving (P)</i> Perceiving types are flexible and spontaneous.

MBTI Personality Traits and Their Real-Life Meaning

Category	Trait	What it Means (Preference)
How you get energy / recharge	Extraversion (E)	Get energy from being around people, active and outgoing
	Introversion (I)	Recharge by spending time alone, quiet and reflective
How you take in information	Sensing (S)	Prefer facts, details, and real experiences
	Intuition (N)	Prefer ideas, patterns, and imagining possibilities
How you make decisions	Thinking (T)	Make decisions using logic, fairness, and objective analysis
	Feeling (F)	Make decisions using values, empathy, and emotional understanding
How you deal with the world	Judging (J)	You like structure, planning, and making decisions early. You prefer schedules, deadlines, and organizing your environment.
	Perceiving (P)	You prefer to stay open, flexible, and spontaneous. You adapt to changes easily and dislike strict rules or fixed plans.

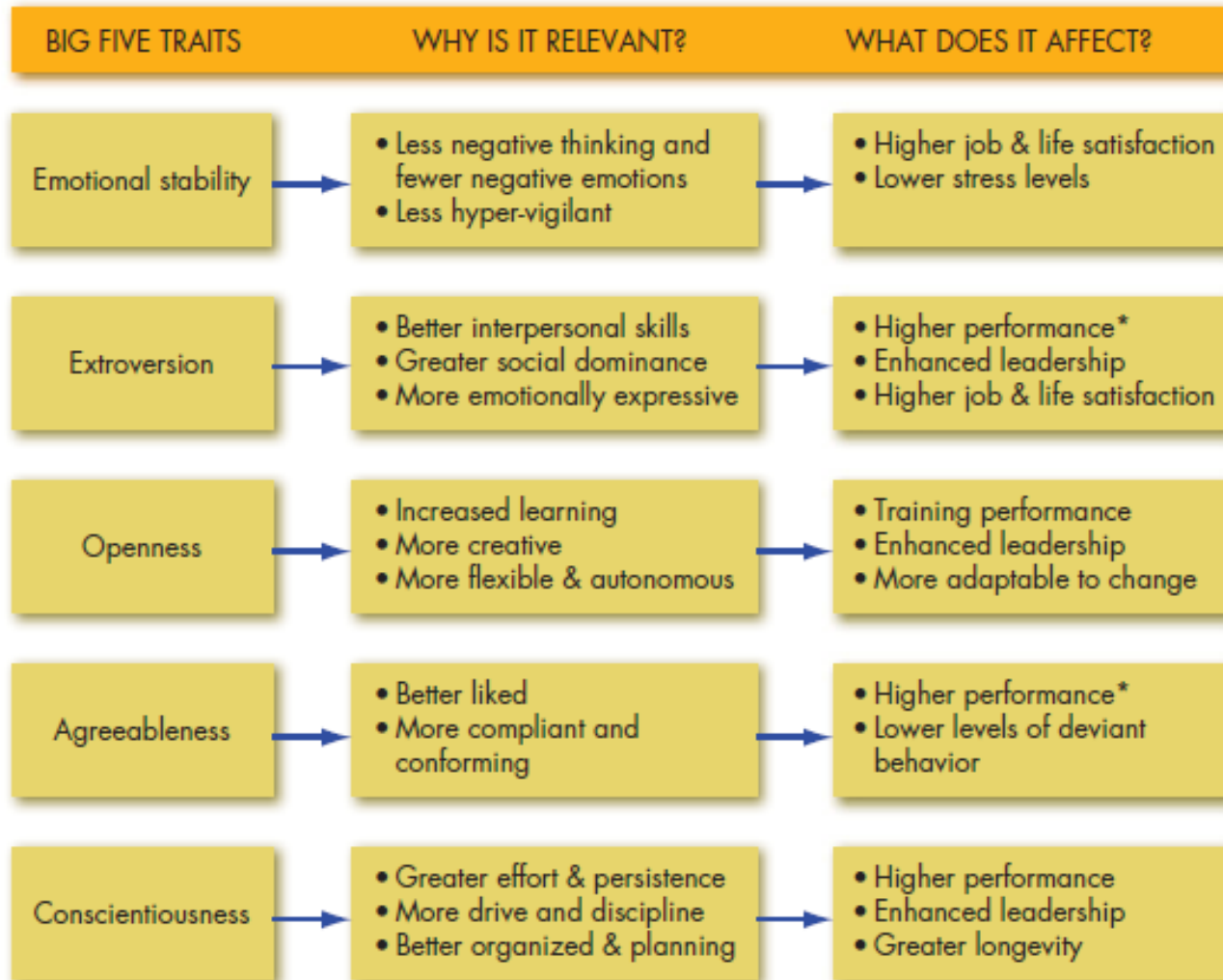
The Big Five Personality Model

1. The **extraversion** dimension captures our comfort level with relationships. Extraverts tend to be gregarious, assertive, and sociable. Introverts tend to be reserved, timid, and quiet.
2. The **agreeableness** dimension refers to an individual's propensity to defer to others. Highly agreeable people are cooperative, warm, and trusting. People who score low on agreeableness are cold, disagreeable, and antagonistic.
3. The **conscientiousness** dimension is a measure of reliability. A highly conscientious person is responsible, organized, dependable. Those who score low on this dimension are easily distracted, disorganized, and unreliable.
4. The **emotional stability** dimension—a person's ability to withstand stress. People with positive emotional stability tend to be calm, self-confident, and secure. Those with high negative scores tend to be nervous, anxious, depressed, and insecure.
5. The **openness to experience** dimension addresses range of interests and fascination with novelty. Extremely open people are creative, curious, and artistically sensitive. Those at the other end of the category are conventional and find comfort in the familiar.

How Do the Big Five Traits Predict Behavior at Work?

Exhibit 5-2

Model of How Big Five Traits Influence OB Criteria



Other Personality Traits Relevant to OB

- **Core Self-Evaluation**

People who have positive **core self-evaluations** like themselves and see themselves as effective, capable, and in control of their environment. Those with negative core self-evaluations tend to dislike themselves, question their capabilities, and view themselves as powerless over their environment

- **But what about job performance?** People with positive core self-evaluations perform better than others because they set more ambitious goals, are more committed to their goals, and persist longer in attempting to reach these goals.
- **Can we be too positive? What happens when someone thinks he is capable but is actually incompetent?** One study of *Fortune* 500 CEOs showed that many are overconfident, and their perceived infallibility often causes them to make bad decisions

Other Personality Traits Relevant to OB

- **Self-Monitoring**

Self-monitoring refers to an individual's ability to adjust his or her behavior to external, situational factors.

- Individuals high in self-monitoring show considerable adaptability in adjusting their behavior to external situational factors. They are highly sensitive to external cues and can behave differently in different situations, sometimes presenting striking contradictions between their public persona and their private self.
- Evidence indicates high self-monitors pay closer attention to the behavior of others and are more capable of conforming than are low self-monitors

Other Personality Traits Relevant to OB

- **Risk Taking**

People differ in their willingness to take chances, a quality that affects how much time and information they need to make a decision.

For instance, 79 managers worked on simulated exercises that required them to make hiring decisions.

High risk-taking managers made more rapid decisions and used less information than did the low risk takers. Interestingly, decision accuracy was the same for both groups.

Other Personality Traits Relevant to OB

- **Proactive Personality**

Those with a **proactive personality** identify opportunities, show initiative, take action, and persevere until meaningful change occurs, compared to others who passively react to situations.

Proactive create positive change in their environment, regardless of, or even in spite of, constraints or obstacles.

Not surprisingly, they have many desirable behaviors that organizations want.

Values

- **Values** are the motive behind purposeful action. They are the ends to which we act and come in many forms.
- Personal **values** are personal beliefs about right and wrong and may or may not be considered moral.
- Cultural **values** are **values** accepted by religions or societies and reflect what is important in each context.
- Are values fluid and flexible? Generally speaking, no. They tend to be relatively stable and enduring.

Values



- A significant portion of the values we hold is established in our early years—by parents, teachers, friends, and others.
- As children, we are told certain behaviors or outcomes are *always* desirable or *always* undesirable, with few gray areas.
- You were never taught to be just a little bit honest or a little bit responsible.
- There is also evidence linking personality to values, implying our values may be partly determined by our genetically transmitted traits

Values influence attitudes and behavior.

- Suppose you enter an organization with the view that allocating pay on the basis of performance is right, while allocating pay on the basis of seniority is wrong.
- How will you react if you find the organization you've just joined rewards seniority and not performance?
- You're likely to be disappointed—and this can lead to job dissatisfaction and a decision not to exert a high level of effort because “It's probably not going to lead to more money anyway.”
- Would your attitudes and behavior be different if your values aligned with the organization's pay policies? Most likely.

Exhibit 5-4

Dominant Work Values in Today's Workforce

Cohort	Entered the Workforce	Approximate Current Age	Dominant Work Values
Boomers	1965–1985	Mid-40s to mid-60s	Success, achievement, ambition, dislike of authority; loyalty to career
Xers	1985–2000	Late 20s to early 40s	Work/life balance, team-oriented, dislike of rules; loyalty to relationships
Nexters	2000 to present	Under 30	Confident, financial success, self-reliant but team-oriented; loyalty to both self and relationships

Generation

Values

Baby Boomers (1946–1964)

Known for **loyalty**, **long working hours**, and **respect for hierarchy**. Came of age in a time of **economic growth**, which supported **long-term employment**.

Gen X (1965–1980)

Often labeled the “**latchkey generation**”, they value **independence**, **efficiency**, and **work-life balance**. Their career values formed during **recessions and downsizing** in the 80s and 90s.

Millennials (1981–1996)

Grew up with the internet and economic instability; thus they value **purpose**, **growth**, and **feedback**. They’re **comfortable with job mobility**, and **flexibility** is essential to them.

Gen Z (1997–2012)

Raised in the digital age, they expect **inclusivity**, **instant communication**, **tech integration**, and are more open to **non-traditional work** (freelance, remote, etc.). Social issues and **mental health** matter a lot to them.

Linking an Individual's Personality and Values to the Workplace

how well the individual's personality *and* values match the organization

- person–job fit
- person–organization fit

Person–Job Fit

- John Holland’s **personality–job fit theory**
- Holland presents six personality types and proposes that satisfaction and the propensity to leave a position depend on how well individuals match their personalities to a job

Exhibit 5-5

Holland’s Typology of Personality and Congruent Occupations

Type	Personality Characteristics	Congruent Occupations
<i>Realistic</i> : Prefers physical activities that require skill, strength, and coordination	Shy, genuine, persistent, stable, conforming, practical	Mechanic, drill press operator, assembly-line worker, farmer
<i>Investigative</i> : Prefers activities that involve thinking, organizing, and understanding	Analytical, original, curious, independent	Biologist, economist, mathematician, news reporter
<i>Social</i> : Prefers activities that involve helping and developing others	Sociable, friendly, cooperative, understanding	Social worker, teacher, counselor, clinical psychologist
<i>Conventional</i> : Prefers rule-regulated, orderly, and unambiguous activities	Conforming, efficient, practical, unimaginative, inflexible	Accountant, corporate manager, bank teller, file clerk
<i>Enterprising</i> : Prefers verbal activities in which there are opportunities to influence others and attain power	Self-confident, ambitious, energetic, domineering	Lawyer, real estate agent, public relations specialist, small business manager
<i>Artistic</i> : Prefers ambiguous and unsystematic activities that allow creative expression	Imaginative, disorderly, idealistic, emotional, impractical	Painter, musician, writer, interior decorator

Person–Organization Fit

- If an organization faces a dynamic and changing environment and requires employees able to readily change tasks and move easily between teams, it's more important that employees' personalities fit with the overall organization's culture than with the characteristics of any specific job.
- This match predicts job satisfaction, commitment to the organization, and low turnover. 80 Interestingly, some research found that person-organization fit was more important in predicting turnover in a collectivistic nation (India) than in a more individualistic nation (the United States).

International Values

Hofstede's value dimensions of national culture.

1. Power distance
2. *Individualism versus collectivism.*
3. *Masculinity versus femininity.*
4. Uncertainty avoidance .
5. *Long-term versus short-term orientation*
6. Indulgence vs. restraint

Hofstede's value dimensions of national culture.

Power distance index :

- The power distance index is defined as "the extent to which the less powerful members of organizations and institutions (like the family) accept and expect that power is distributed unequally".
- A higher degree of the Index indicates that hierarchy is clearly established and executed in society, without doubt or reason.
- A lower degree of the Index signifies that people question authority and attempt to distribute power.

Individualism vs. collectivism :

- This index explores the "degree to which people in a society are integrated into groups".
- Individualistic societies have loose ties that often only relate an individual to his/her immediate family. They emphasize **the "I" versus the "we"**.
- Its counterpart, collectivism, describes a society in which tightly integrated relationships tie extended families and others into in-groups.

Uncertainty avoidance:

- The uncertainty avoidance index is defined as "**a society's tolerance for ambiguity**", in which people embrace or avert an event of something unexpected, unknown
- Societies that score a high degree in this index opt for stiff codes of behavior, guidelines, laws, and generally rely on absolute truth, or the belief that one lone truth dictates everything and that people know what it is.
- A lower degree in this index shows more acceptance of differing thoughts or ideas. Society tends to impose fewer regulations, ambiguity is more accustomed to, and the environment is more free-flowing.

Masculinity vs. femininity:

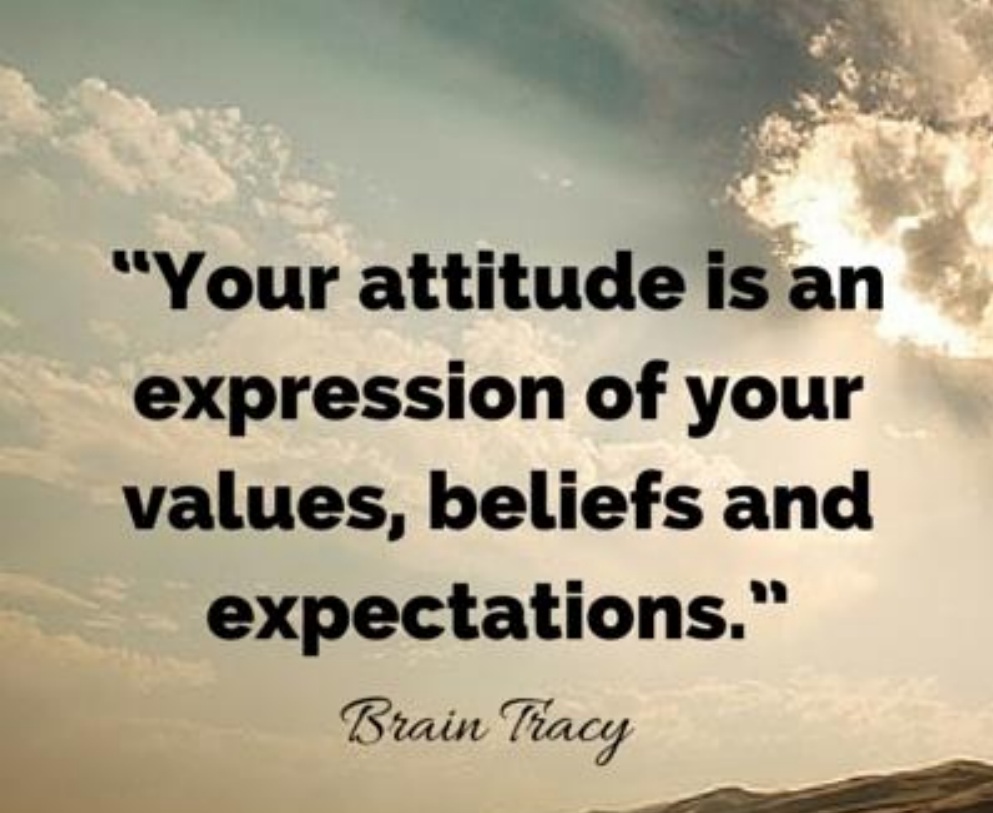
- Masculinity is defined as "**a preference in society for achievement, heroism, assertiveness, and material rewards for success.**"
- Its counterpart represents "**a preference for cooperation, modesty, caring for the weak, and quality of life.**" Women in the respective societies tend to display different values.
- In feminine societies, they share modest and caring views equally with men.
- In more masculine societies, women are somewhat assertive and competitive, but notably less than men.
- In other words, they still recognize a gap between male and female values. This dimension is frequently viewed as taboo in highly masculine societies.

Long-term orientation vs. short-term orientation :

- This dimension associates the connection of the past with the current and future actions/challenges.
- A lower degree of this index (short-term) indicates that traditions are honored and kept, while steadfastness is valued.
- Societies with a high degree in this index (long-term) view adaptation and circumstantial, pragmatic problem-solving as a necessity.
- A poor country that is short-term oriented usually has little to no economic development, while long-term oriented countries continue to develop to a level of prosperity.

Indulgence vs. restraint:

- This dimension refers to the degree of freedom/tolerance that societal norms give to citizens in fulfilling their human desires.
- Indulgence is defined as "a society that allows relatively free gratification of basic and natural human desires related to enjoying life and having fun".
- Its counterpart is defined as "a society that controls gratification of needs and regulates it by means of strict social norms"



**“Your attitude is an
expression of your
values, beliefs and
expectations.”**

Brain Tracy

**it costs
\$0.00 to be
a nice person.**

THANK YOU....

& don't forget...

Your VALUES

Your ATTITUDES

Your ORGANIZATION.